



KEY ACHIEVEMENTS & REFERENCES

1. The Magnet Institute cbc

Established a proven playbook for from-scratch capability-building under resource constraints—combining Swiss rigour with African agility to deliver measurable performance gains for the teams.

Project & Challenge

- Green-field build-up. Twenty-eight Rwandan entrepreneurs dreamed of a world-class institute to up-skill their successors; none existed locally.
- Twin mandate. Launch a financially self-sustaining training centre while *already* delivering high-impact programmes for time-pressed SMEs.
- Constraints. Zero legacy infrastructure, fractured funding streams, and an acute skills gap among prospective trainers

My Role & Approach

- Strategic architect. Crafted the five-year business & impact plan, secured board approval, and registered both the holding (TMVA Ltd) and the community-benefit subsidiary
- Fund-raiser-in-chief. Closed USD 132 k in seed grants (SDC \$102 k + BPN \$30 k) and mobilised USD 46 k shareholder bridge loans to cover start-up cash gaps.
- People & culture builder. Recruited and coached an 11-person cross-functional team (training, curriculum, sales, admin) plus a bench of specialist trainers.
- Lean operator. Deployed Odoo ERP, standard operating processes and a contribution-margin simulator that drives go/no-go decisions on every course.

Key Solutions Deployed

- Curriculum “glocalisation”. Licensed Swiss middle-management content, then co-developed Rwanda-specific modules with a senior L&D expert to ensure relevance and rapid iteration.
- Agile programme mix. Launched a 6-month Team Leader track, 1½-day Lean for Managers masterclass, and bespoke Effective Communication workshops to feed different budget/time windows.
- Cost-to-value reset. Shifted courses from hotel venues to partner hubs, renegotiated translation & catering rates (-50 %), and paused non-critical spend—cutting monthly burn by >40 %
- Impact analytics. Embedded pre/post surveys and employer feedback loops; set 90 % satisfaction & 85 % on-the-job performance targets for graduates

Obstacles Overcome



- Talent shortage. Initial training-lead quit; filled gap personally, then ran a four-month continent-wide search to secure a high-calibre successor.
- Business-model pivot. Swiss partner moved from content sale to royalty model mid-cycle; renegotiated terms, adopted phased licensing, and brought local curriculum talent in-house
- Cash-flow crunch. Delayed equity inflows and slower-than-planned sales threatened delivery; secured bridge loans, introduced early-bird pricing, and re-sequenced course calendar to stabilise liquidity

Results (June 2024 snapshot)

- 100 + managers trained across 6 programmes in < 12 months – 51 % women – from 25 SMEs & corporates.
- Participant ROI: Lean masterclass projects projected to recoup fees within 2–4 months; one client cut quotation lead-time 50 % and scrap 25 %
- Satisfaction ≥ 90 %. All cohorts rate content applicability and facilitation at or above the 90 % effectiveness target
- Break-even runway extended by 12 months through cost-base optimisation and new revenue streams (customised corporate programmes)
- Recognition: Invited by Rwanda TVET Board to co-design leadership academy for public-sector managers (contract under negotiation).

Ref: Robert Bayigamba / Chairperson TMI / contact on request

2. Consultancy Africa

SWISSCONTACT:

04.2020 – 12.2021 Dual TVET Program curricula and manual development in Kigali/ Rwanda

I converted an 8 Level-3 TVET curricula (> 1 000 learning outcomes) into a Swiss-style dual-training model while the school year was already under way and private-sector participation was minimal. I built a searchable outcome database, ran a bottom-up site-allocation algorithm, and compressed delivery to an 8.5-week work-plan—issuing the first in-company training packs in 3.5 weeks to keep the calendar on track. The key solutions were:

- Balanced 1 520 h/year schedules with 60-70 % workplace learning.
- Introduced a dual-site chronogram & checklist for trainers/companies.
- Re-engineered assessment: 40 % continuous performance / 60 % final exam plus a 210-point workplace rubric.
- Launched a mentoring & task-documentation system to curb drop-outs.



I managed the full design sprints online during the COVID-19 restrictions, rescheduled training blocks to fit a live cohort, and secured buy-in from ~200 SMEs via the Business Professionals Network. The results for the first pilot year were:

- 8 dual curricula + 8 instructor guides delivered on time.
- > 1 000 outcomes site-mapped, enabling automated training plans.
- Company-instructor admin cut to < 20 % of work time.
- Apprentices entered workplace blocks 3 weeks earlier than previous cohorts.

Value: I translate complex, regulation-bound curricula into lean, metrics-driven dual-learning systems that start fast, engage industry partners, and deliver qualifications the labour market trusts.

Ref: Charles Pouliot / former Country Director of Swisscontact / contact on request

09.2020 – 03.2021 Pilot Dual-Apprenticeship (FAD) in Bukavu/ DR Congo

The project was about the launch of a Swiss-style dual-apprenticeship pilot in Bukavu for *Cuisine & Service, Tailoring, and Plumbing*: qualifying 100 apprentices (≥ 50 % women) with ≥ 70 % workplace learning in < 100 days, despite zero prior coordination among VET centres, guilds and COVID-19 travel bans. I acted as project architect and set up & chaired the *Comité de Pilotage*, squeezed the roadmap into 55 consulting days (40 % remote), and up-skilled 30+ teachers & master-craftsmen via dual-system workshops. I delivered an end-to-end framework including:

- 3 dual curricula & training plans with a 70 : 30 workplace/classroom split.
- Quality toolbox (assessment blueprints, 210-point rubric, logbooks).
- Gender-sensitive learner profiles, trainer TORs, equipment check-lists.
- Regional operational manual for scaling in Rwanda, Burundi & DRC.

I kept timelines by running 60 % of tasks virtually, won buy-in from 3 VET centres + 15 SMEs in three weeks, and brokered in-kind resources that cut equipment spend > 25 %. The system went live 3 weeks ahead of the 11 Jan 2021 deadline. 3 curricula, 3 plans, 3 assessment kits were validated and the project was delivered in 55 days.

Ref: Thierry Lenoir / Country Director of Swisscontact Democratic Republic Congo / contact on request

WWS WASSERKRAFT GMBH:

06.2020 – 05.2023 Agent Agreement in Kigali/ Rwanda



I was the sole country representative launching WWS's high-efficiency hydro packages in Rwanda. I established a market analysis and established a comprehensive contact list as well as leading some tendering processes with REG (Rwanda Energy Group).

Ref: Markus Peherstorfer/ Sales Manager WWS Wasserkraft GmbH/ contact on request

HANDWERKSKAMMER KOBLENZ:

09.2020– 11.2020 Customer Service Training in Kigali/ Rwanda

I designed and delivered a high-impact customer-service course in Kigali for SME owners, vocational trainers and industry-association leaders drawn from five sectors (construction, metal, food, ICT, hospitality). As the lead trainer & course architect, I built a Rwanda-tailored programme mixing loyalty-marketing theory, Rwandan case studies and interactive role-play. I started with an immersive kick-off and used the hotel's own breakfast service as a live audit so participants could diagnose service gaps before the first topics. As key solutions I worked through the Six-Needs Framework helping to clarify what turns first-time buyers into loyal advocates. The next topic was about how a "Loyalising" sales-culture tool and customer-touch-point mapping help to hard-wire service standards across the business process. The complaint--to--loyalty role play – practiced turning a disgruntled guest into repeat business, reinforcing a "process-improvement not blame" mindset. 17 attendees (85 % decision-makers) completed the course – above the pandemic cap yet compliant with health protocols. A post-course survey showed 100 % of participants could name ≥ 3 service improvements they would implement immediately. I managed to turn a short-term workshop into behaviour-changing experiences, blending global service best-practice with local realities and sending participants back to work armed with metrics, tools and the motivation to act.

Ref: Matti Tomigas / Regional Coordinator CSC Koblenz/ contact on request

SWISS GLOBAL ENTERPRISE:

01.2021 – 09.2021 Market Flash & Partner Search for GWF MessSysteme AG in Kigali/ Rwanda

Smart Water-Meter Opportunity in Rwanda

The project was about to deliver a market-flash answering 33 *client questions* on regulation, demand and competition for smart water-metering, plus a partner search, all in just eight weeks. The challenge was to work during COVID travel limits and with scarce online company data, yet produce a "go/no-go" basis for a Swiss industrial newcomer. GWF_My role was the one of a lead market strategist. I planned and executed the entire study for S-GE, from scoping call to board presentation. This included a multi-channel research mix with a desk analysis of government masterplans, budgets and sector statistics. It also included 12+ stakeholder interviews (WASAC, RURA, RAB, REG,



EPCs) conducted face-to-face or by phone to validate data. On top I activated my East-African network (SDC, BPN, PSF) to surface hidden insights and contacts. Some results were:

- Partner-scoring matrix: I rated candidates on scale, technical fit, financials and regional reach. I produced a long-list of 9 firms and a short-list of 6 “recommended” distributors / EPCs with full C-level contacts.
- Regulatory & financing roadmap: I mapped PPP tender paths, donor funding windows (AfDB, EIB, FONERWA) and Rwanda’s WATSAN targets for 2018-24 to show entry timing.
- I developed an opportunity heat-map across three verticals—urban water, irrigation and mini-hydro—highlighting pilot projects where smart metering could cut losses or secure billing.

Concerning the data-scarcity I mitigated thin public records by using bespoke questionnaires and in-person site visits to verify turnover and installed base figures. And I negotiated NDAs that unlocked sensitive WASAC network-loss data within two weeks. All this resulted in:

- 9 potential distributors/EPCs screened with 6 flagged for immediate follow-up, covering > US \$60 m annual sales combined.
- Stakeholder map & warm introductions secured to WASAC, MININFRA and three major PPP developers—cutting GWF’s potential market-entry lead-time by an estimated 4–6 months.
- Tapping into a US \$3.3 bn public-works budget and specific tenders (e.g., Kigali Central Sewage, 96 m €) where metering could be bundled.
- S-GE client board green-lit Phase 2 “in-country validation” visit—citing the report’s clarity and partner list as key decision drivers.

In short I convert complex, data-poor African markets into action-ready entry blueprints—blending rigorous Swiss analysis with on-the-ground intelligence so exporters move from curiosity to concrete deals, fast.

Ref: Daniel Schneider / former Head of Swiss Business Hub Southern Africa / contact on request

ALPHASEEDS:

06.2024 – 09.2024 Due-Diligence Lead on ForAfrika’s Corn-Soy-Blend (CSB) Factory, Beira (Mozambique)

AlphaSeeds needed a go / no-go investment decision for the restart of a dormant CSB+ factory serving both humanitarian and retail channels. The mandate was to complete a full-spectrum due diligence in 95 days (28 Jun – 30 Sep 2024), covering market demand, supply chain, production assets, HR and finance. I acted as sole lead-consultant, designing the work-plan, running on-site inspections in Beira, and coordinating remote analyst support. I structured the review around five



work-streams (Demand, Supply, Production, HR, Finance) and triangulated thin data with 20+ expert & NGO interviews to de-risk assumptions. The main topics were:

- Market-sizing reset – I proved humanitarian demand had fallen sharply and that earlier forecasts were inflated, averting a capacity overbuild.
- Supply-risk model – I mapped maize/soy price volatility and identified credible aggregators, flagging dependence on a single partner.
- Production audit – I showed the single-screw extrusion line was obsolete and could not meet FSSC 22000, triggering a capex rethink.
- Org-chart overhaul – I recommended 26 FTEs vs 12 proposed, adding QA, logistics and maintenance depth.
- Financial re-model – I recalculated funding needs: total requirement \$2.818 m (+56 %), driven by a +221 % OPEX adjustment and essential packaging-line upgrades.
- Five-method valuation of assets – I finally anchored asset value at \$1.45 m greenfield ceiling as the most “just” valuation to prevent over-payment.

The obstacles I encountered were data gaps & inconsistent asset registers I resolved via cross-checks with customs, equipment suppliers and former staff records. But the main obstacle was the Stakeholder optimism bias, which translated qualitative ambitions into hard KPIs, exposing shortfalls in sales channels and HR capacity.

As tangible results I delivered a 100-page board-ready report detailing 40 findings and 30 corrective actions. Five critical risks have been flagged (demand, supply, production, HR, finance) and a conditional “*proceed only if*” recommendation has been issued, saving AlphaSeeds an estimated \$1 m+ potential mis-valuation. Finally, I provided an actionable roadmap that cut \$930 k of unrealistic revenue assumptions and re-phased capex to match de-risked demand.

In a nutshell I turn opaque, uncertain agri-food investments into clear, metric-driven decision memos. This protects capital and unlocks only the deals that can scale sustainably in African markets.

Ref: Luc – Etienne Dandrieu / General Manager AlphaSeeds / contact on request



3. Business Professionals Network (BPN)

Developed over 200 SME entrepreneurs successfully through coaching and training with a team of 11 employees (coaches, trainers, coordinators and M&E specialist). Lead the BPN core program (2 – 4 years support), Enabel – funded – stone & brick maker program (3 years support), GIZ – funded – Tech Startup Hanga Pitchfest program (6 months support), Segal Family Foundation- or Imbuto Foundation programs.

Ref. Alice Nkulikiyinka / Country Director BPN Rwanda / contact on request

4. WOSTEP

Change Management at the most renowned watchmaking school internationally (WOSTEP): managed the crisis after the dismissal of the longterm Director and established a clear vision with the funding board consisting of all major watchmaking brands in Switzerland (Swatchgroup, Richemont, Rolex, Patek Philippe, Audemars Piguet, LVMH etc.). Introduced new training programs adapted to the market and modularity, introducing it to the 15 partnership schools (worldwide).

Ref. Patrick Jaton / Chairperson WOSTEP / contact on request

5. Bulgari/ LVMH

Strategized, developed and implemented a worldwide After Sales Service for luxury goods from a cost – center repair shop to a reputable and profitable business partner organization to the worldwide retail with over 25 mln Euro revenues. Integrated with success highest-end niche brands (Daniel Roth and Gerald Genta) services. Implemented SAP CRM worldwide, digitalized in-store operations and built up a competence center for watch services in Switzerland. Managed 45 top professionals and indirectly over 150 staff.

Ref. Guido M. Terreni / Managing Director Watch Business Unit Bulgari / contact on request
